

213 Grow your own stalactites

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Stalactites form when minerals dissolved in water are left behind as the water drips from the moist ceilings of caves. With this simple project, you can grow your own in just a few days.

What you need

- 2 glass jars • Shallow dish
- Spoon • 2 paper clips
- Hot tap water • Pitcher
- 3 ft (1 m) length of yarn
- Baking soda

1 Set the jars on either side of the dish. Fold the strand of yarn in half, then fold it in half again. Twist it tightly.

2 Attach a paper clip to each end of the yarn. Put one end in each jar. Move the jars close enough to make a dip in the yarn.

3 Add baking soda to a pitcherful of hot tap water until no more dissolves. This makes a concentrated solution.

4 Pour the solution into both jars, and keep any leftovers to top off as needed. Stalactite crystals will appear in 2–3 days.



214 Tell stalactites from stalagmites

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Stalactites hang from the top of caves, while stalagmites form on cave floors. To remember the difference, think of the “c” in stalactite standing for “ceiling” and the “g” in stalagmite standing for “ground.”

Stalagmites reach up

